

EFF launches open source code security program

The Electronic Frontier Foundation (EFF) has launched a new security initiative to identify the vulnerabilities in open source code.

The open source world is showing increasing interest in leveraging the community to shore up software security in the wake of embarrassments like Heartbleed. The EFF initiative, called the Security Vulnerability Disclosure Program, will advocate online freedom and openness.

The EFF maintains several security tools for protecting privacy. When tools that are designed to protect users' privacy and security turn out to have flaws, they leave the users with a false sense of security. The EFF's Security Vulnerability Disclosure Program is an effort to curtail these risks by encouraging members of the open source communities to inspect code, as well as particular software configurations, for vulnerabilities.

In this sense, the programme falls in line with similar initiatives introduced over the last couple of years. The Linux Foundation had launched the Open Core Initiative in April 2014 to help focus attention on software security in open source projects. Last spring, the Foundation took similar steps by building up the Let's Encrypt project for better browser security.

Taken together, the EFF's programme and these other initiatives help set the open source software world apart from its proprietary counterpart when it comes to security.

Open source programmers are now willing to admit that their code inevitably has flaws.

In fact, they are recognising that it has so many flaws that they alone cannot identify and fix them all. So groups like the EFF are relying on the community at large to help secure their code.

Mozilla kills Firefox OS for smartphones

Mozilla Foundation recently announced that it has killed the Firefox OS for smartphones. This OS for smartphones had created a buzz when it was launched, and was touted as an alternative to Android, giving more freedom to users. However, the OS couldn't get the desired acceptance amongst users, despite getting support from several OEMs from different parts of the world. Hence, the open source operating system maker has decided to kill it.

According to various online reports, Denelle Dixon-Thayer, chief legal and business officer at Mozilla stated, "We are proud of the benefits Firefox OS added to the Web platform and will continue to experiment with the user experience across connected devices. We will build everything we do as a genuine open source project, focused on user experience first and build tools to enable the ecosystem to grow."

"Firefox OS proved the flexibility of the Web, scaling from low-end smartphones all the way up to HD TVs. However, we weren't able to offer the best user experience possible and so we will stop offering Firefox OS on smartphones through carrier channels. We'll share more on our work and new experiments across connected devices soon," he said.

Firefox OS first came into being as a project called Boot2Gecko, which brought the idea of a mobile operating system that delivers applications using the Web. Unfortunately, despite the idea being innovative, it did not convert into a good business proposition for Mozilla. Despite several attempts, Mozilla failed to penetrate the mobile landscape dominated by Android and iOS. Other operating systems, including Windows, BlackBerry, Tizen and Ubuntu, are also making an effort to enter this space, but their volumes too, as of now, are very low.

CampaignChain — the cockpit for digital marketing

A German start-up called CampaignChain has launched a private beta for a product with the same name. The new product is being marketed as 'the cockpit for digital marketing' because the software acts as a central campaign coordinator for other marketing tools. Potential users can apply to participate in the beta launch.



CampaignChain can be used for planning, creating and editing campaign reports for email, social and other campaigns. It can also be executed as an integrated tool. For example, an email newsletter is scheduled in the

ChampaignChain mail chimp implementation. It is required to be created in the Mail Chimp. Besides this, the beta version includes integration for Twitter, Facebook, LinkedIn, YouTube, Slideshare, 3z Magnolia Content Systems, Citrix Gotowebinar, Google Analytics with the website.

Sources at CampaignChain claim that the start-up has received an unspecified amount of angel funding from an IT solutions provider called YMC and from many individuals too.